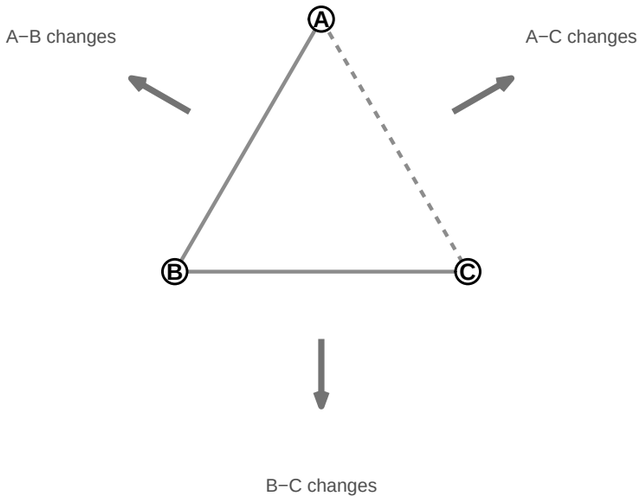
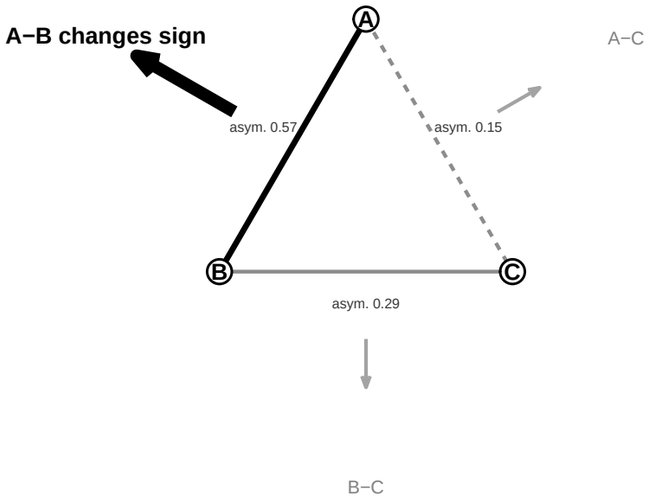
A. The allocation problem

Imbalance creates pressure to adjust, not where it lands



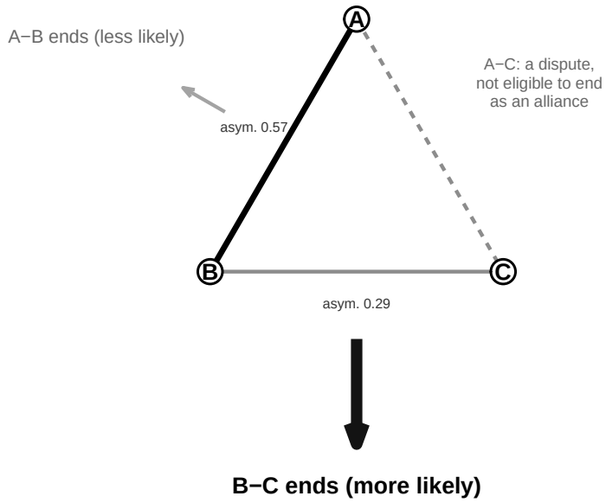
B. Bend (H1a)

Asymmetric ties are more likely to change sign



C. Break (H1b)

Asymmetric alliances are less likely to end outright



Dependence asymmetry channels adjustment: asymmetric relationships are more likely to bend than to break.